

PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · GRAPH

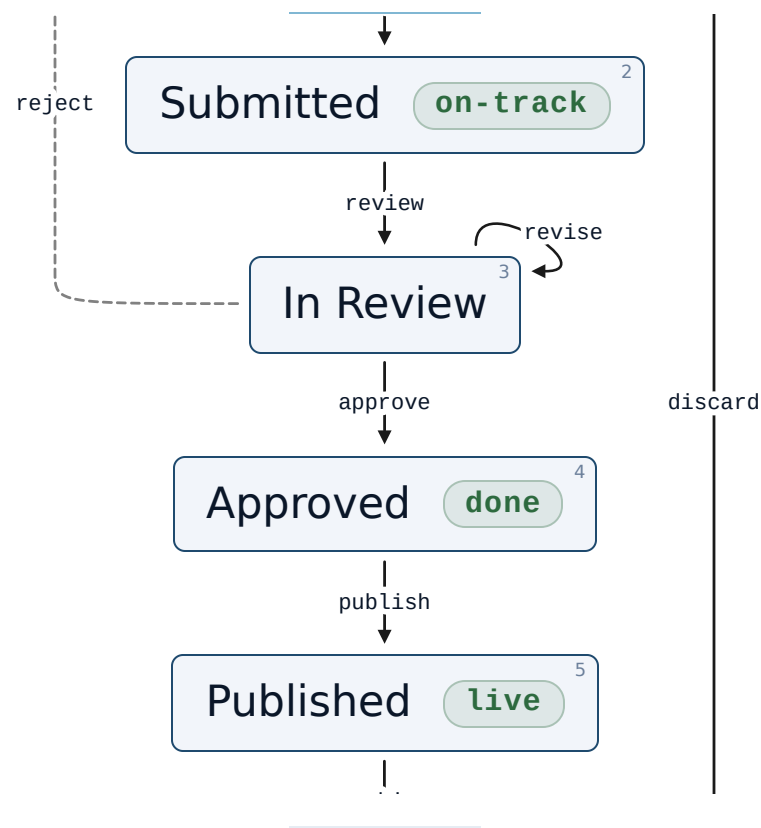
state-chart

Native state machine diagram — states as a numbered list, transitions as nested inline-code refs.

SUBMISSION LIFECYCLE

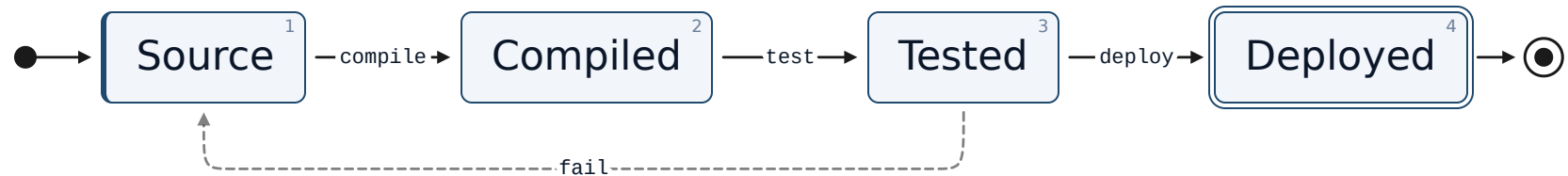
Document approval flow.

How a draft moves from author to archive.

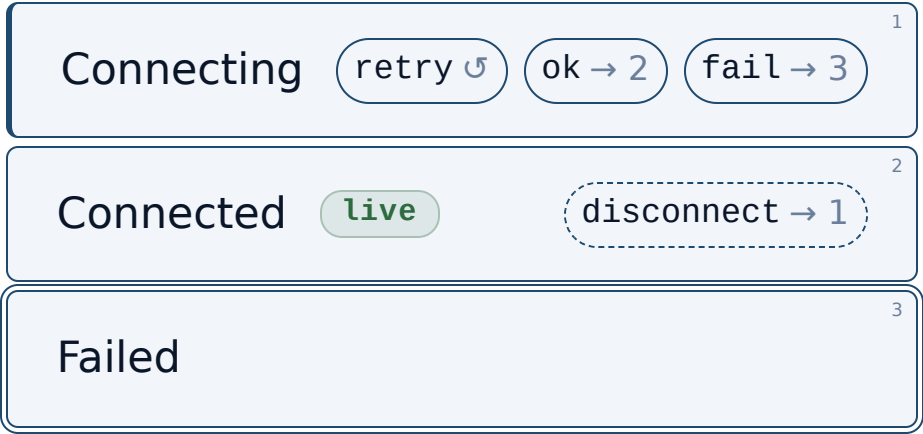


Rejected drafts return to the author; revisions stay in review.

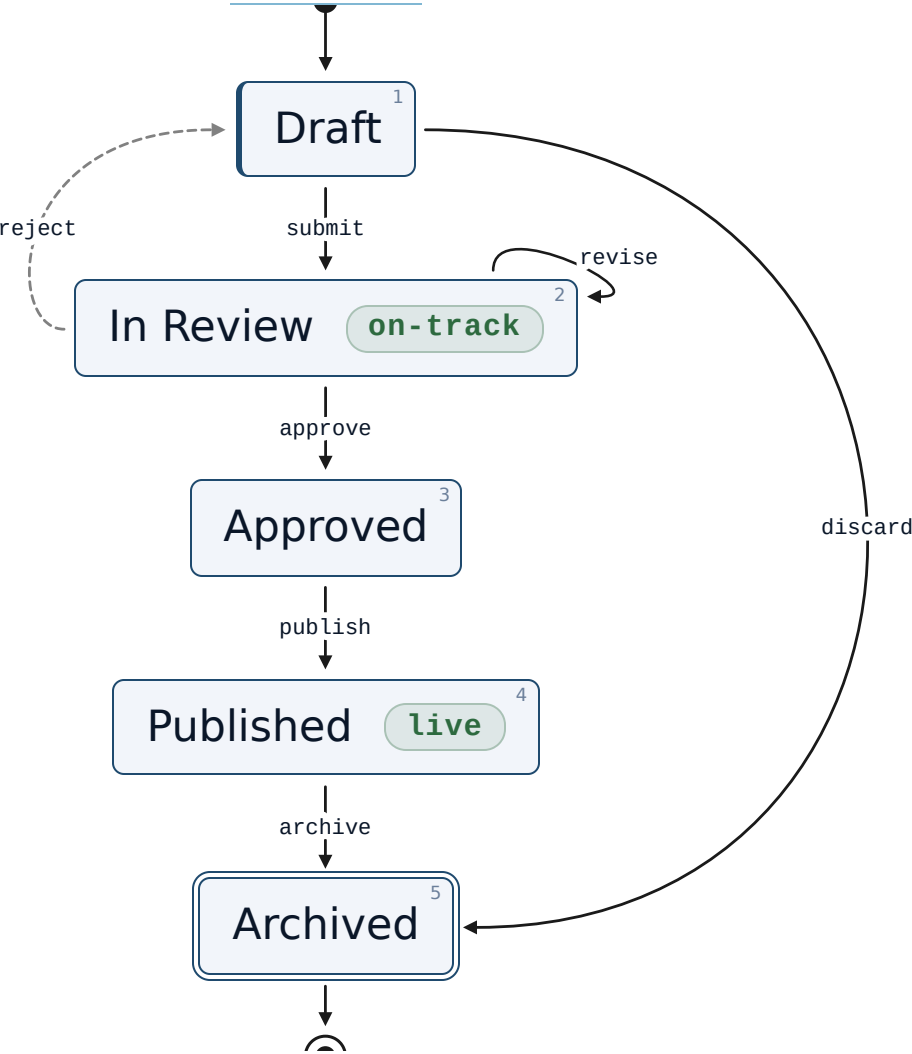
Build pipeline.



Connection retry.



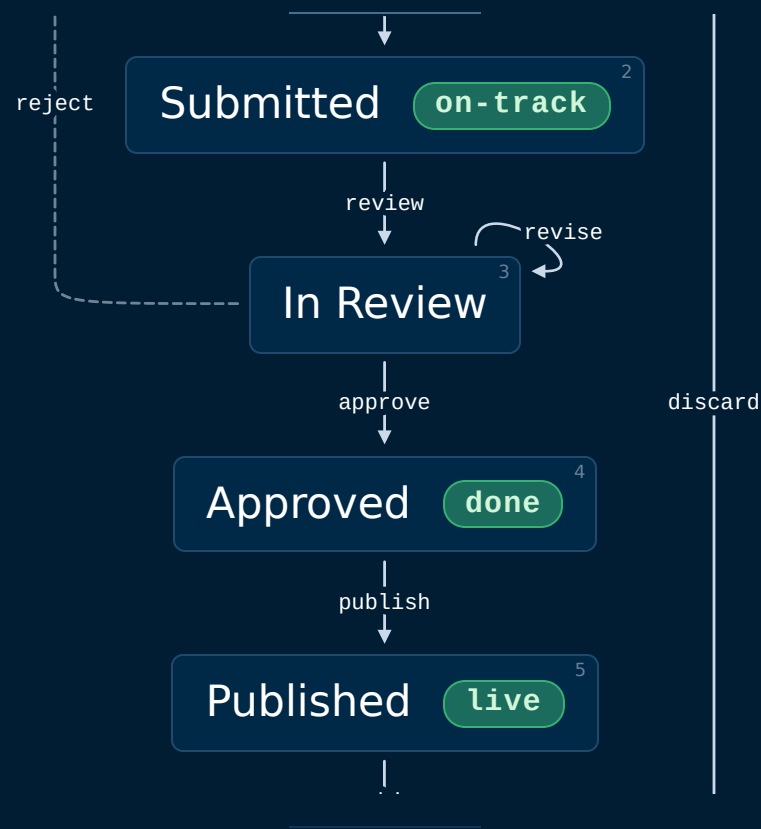
Document approval (curved).



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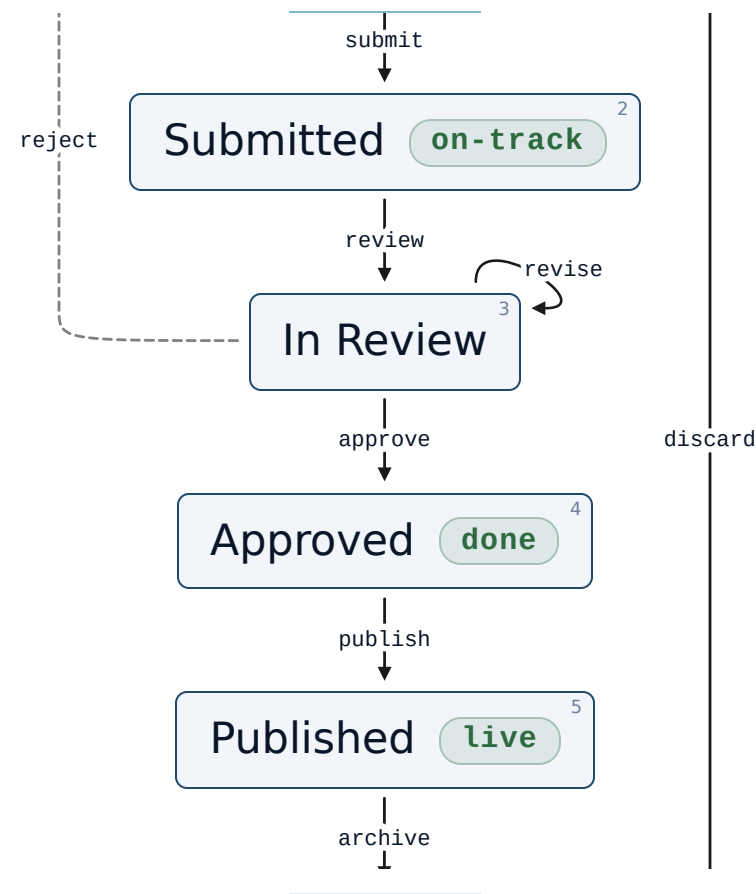


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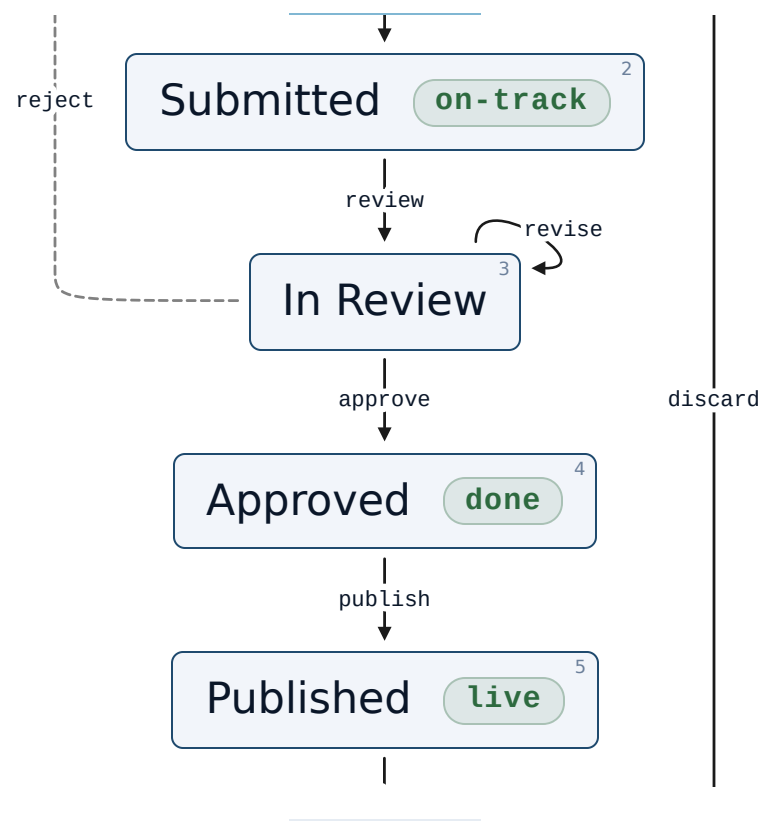


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When NOT to reach for state-chart.

More than ~8 states. Vertical stacks of ten or more states stop reading as a machine and start reading as a list. If the system has many states, group them into phases and show one phase at a time, or step back to a higher-level abstraction. The chart's job is to make the topology obvious in one glance.

Hierarchical or parallel states. v1 grammar is one flat list of states with one outgoing arrow per nested bullet. Composite states, orthogonal regions, history nodes — anything Mermaid's `stateDiagram-v2` does and this layout doesn't — belong in a Mermaid fence via the `diagram` component.

Continuous processes. If the diagram is really a workflow with stages that overlap or block (queue depth, throughput, capacity), a `gantt` or `kanban` chart reads better. State charts are for discrete, mutually-exclusive states the system flips between.

See also.

RELATED COMPONENTS

diagram — the machine has hierarchical states, parallel regions, or guards that need Mermaid's full state-diagram grammar

journey — the sequence is a user's path through tasks with mood / affect, not a system's discrete states

timeline-list — events are points in time rather than transitions between named states

list-steps — a linear procedure with no branching — state-chart is overkill if there are no choices to make

roadmap — parallel workstreams across phases, not a single machine's transitions